

Data collectives for members who can't go it alone

How a news network or trade association turns its members' data into one product — and pays them for it.

01 • THE PROBLEM

Your members own valuable data. They can't safely sell it alone.

- AI companies will pay for archives, reports, and member knowledge
- No single small member can build the infra, billing, or access controls
- So the data just sits there

The content already exists. What's missing is shared infrastructure — and someone trusted to run it.

02 · THE IDEA

A data collective

- **One organization** runs the infrastructure
- **Many members** plug in their own data — it stays theirs
- **Buyers** query all of it through one door

Like a co-op: you own the storefront, each member keeps the keys to their unit, and the buyer walks into one shop — not twenty.

03 · ROLES

Two roles, one system

ROLE	WHO	WHAT THEY DO
Host	The association or news network	Runs the infra, manages members, sees everything
Member	Each newsroom or member firm	Connects data, sets pricing, keeps their revenue

Same app, two modes. The host sees the whole collective; each member sees only their own private space.

One dashboard, the whole collective

- **Members** — who's in, who's active, who's earning
- **Collective APIs** — the shared endpoints buyers hit, with revenue each
- **Stats** — total revenue, this month, active and earning members

300

members

47

active this month

10

earning

05 · THE MEMBER'S VIEW

A normal workspace, with the rails built in

- **Sign in once** — no registration; you manage membership
- **Connect data the way they already work:** WordPress · RSS · files & folders
- **Set a price per query** — and keep what they earn

Onboarding a member is "paste a URL and a key" — not "migrate your whole archive."

Many archives become **one product**

- Each member's data becomes **their own API**
- Those APIs roll up into **collective APIs** — e.g. search every member's archive
- Buyers query **one endpoint**, drawn from everyone who opted in

The collective is worth far more than any single archive. That combined value is what only you — the host — can offer.

07 • THE MONEY

Members get paid per query

- Buyers pay **per request** or in **prepaid bundles**
- Members collect to **their own wallet** — or your **shared collective wallet**
- Host sees the whole picture; each member sees their slice

The shared wallet is the unlock: small members don't need their own payment rails to participate.

Better together than alone

- **Aggregation** — buyers want everyone's content; the whole beats the parts
- **Shared cost** — one system, run by the org that already serves members
- **Trust** — you're already the neutral broker holding the keys
- **Leverage** — twenty members negotiating as one

For an association, this is what you already do — pool resources, represent members — applied to data.

09 · WHO RUNS ONE WELL

Built for trusted networks

- **News** — regional paper groups, newsroom networks, journalism consortia
- **Associations** — industry bodies, professional groups, sector coalitions

The pattern: a trusted organization at the center, and members who individually can't build this — but together own something buyers want.

10 · HOW IT FITS TOGETHER

Under the hood

- Host runs **one system** at a public URL they control
- Members join as **isolated tenants** — separate data, shared front door
- Member APIs compose into **collective APIs**
- Access, limits, and pricing enforced as **policies**; revenue routed per wallet

Members never run a server. Buyers never see the seams. You operate one system and manage the rest from the dashboard.